

EXPERIMENT - 3

1. AIM

To design and develop a Student Admission Enquiry Management application using Zoho Creator for collecting and managing prospective students' admission enquiries in a structured manner. The application captures personal details, contact information, academic interests, counselling preferences, and consent using all 13 Basic Fields available in the Zoho Creator Form Builder. It also aims to implement appropriate field validations, store submitted enquiries in a report, and support the Admission Cell in reviewing and following up with prospective students.

2. Traditional Application Development vs Emerging Trends in Low-Code Application Development

2.1 Traditional Application Development

Traditional application development is a conventional method of developing software by writing and managing the application code manually. It involves different stages such as requirement analysis, system design, coding, testing, debugging, deployment, and maintenance. Developers use programming languages and frameworks such as Java, Python, C#, JavaScript, etc., to build applications. This approach provides a high level of customization and control over the application. However, it generally requires skilled developers, more development time, and greater effort for testing and maintenance.

2.2 Low-Code Application Development

Low-code application development is a modern approach that allows applications to be developed with minimal hand-written code. It provides visual development tools such as drag-and-drop components, pre-built forms, templates, workflows, and database integrations. Platforms such as Zoho Creator allow users to create applications without developing every component from scratch. Low-code development reduces development time and makes application development easier for users with limited programming knowledge. It is commonly used for business applications, management systems, forms, reports, and workflow automation.

2.3 Emerging Trends in Low-Code Application Development

Low-code development is becoming increasingly popular due to the demand for faster and simpler software development. Major trends include AI-assisted application development, cloud-based development, workflow automation, reusable components, API integration, mobile application development, and automated testing. Low-code platforms are also providing better integration with databases, third-party applications, and business services.

These developments enable organizations to build and deploy applications rapidly while reducing development and maintenance effort.

3. Benefits and Challenges in Low-Code Application Development

Benefits

1. **Faster Development** – Applications can be created quickly using drag-and-drop components.
2. **Reduced Coding** – Less manual programming is required.
3. **Easy Form Creation** – Different field types can be added and configured easily.
4. **Built-in Validation** – Mandatory fields, formats, and value ranges can be configured without extensive coding.
5. **Workflow Automation** – Emails and other actions can be triggered automatically.
6. **Easy Database Management** – Submitted form records can be stored and viewed through reports.
7. **Easy Maintenance** – Changes to fields and forms can be made quickly.
8. **User-Friendly Interface** – Non-programmers can participate in application development.
9. **Rapid Prototyping** – Applications can be tested and modified during development.
10. **Integration** – Low-code platforms can integrate forms, reports, workflows, and external services.

Challenges

1. **Limited Customization** – Highly complex requirements may require additional coding.
2. **Platform Dependency** – Applications depend on the selected low-code platform.
3. **Performance Limitations** – Very large or complex applications may require traditional development.
4. **Security Concerns** – Proper access control and data protection must be configured.
5. **Learning Platform Features** – Users still need to understand the platform's components and workflow.
6. **Migration Difficulty** – Moving an application from one platform to another may require significant effort.
7. **Customization Restrictions** – Platform-specific limitations may affect application design.

8. **Cost Considerations** – Advanced features may require paid plans depending on the platform.

4. Comparison of Existing Low-Code Platforms

Feature	Zoho Creator	Microsoft Power Apps	Google AppSheet	Mendix
Development Style	Low-code / visual	Low-code / visual	No-code / low-code	Low-code
Form Creation	Available	Available	Available	Available
Database Support	Built-in	Dataverse and other sources	Cloud-based data sources	Built-in/data sources
Workflow Automation	Available	Power Automate integration	Automation bots	Workflow support
Report/Dashboard	Available	Available	Available	Available
Integration	Zoho and third-party services	Microsoft ecosystem and third-party services	Google ecosystem and other services	Enterprise integrations
Programming Requirement	Low	Low	Very low	Low to moderate
Main Advantage	Forms, reports and automation in one platform	Strong Microsoft ecosystem integration	Simple application development	Enterprise-grade application development

Zoho Creator provides visual form building, multiple field types, validation, reports, and workflow automation, which are required for developing the Student Admission Enquiry Management application.

5. RESULT

The Student Admission Enquiry Management application was successfully designed and developed using Zoho Creator.

The Admission_Enquiry_Form was created using all 13 Basic Field types—Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox. The required validation rules, including mandatory fields, email and phone validation, percentage range validation, date restriction, and consent validation, were configured.

The submitted student enquiry details were successfully stored and displayed in the Admission_Enquiry_Report. Sample records were entered and verified, demonstrating that Zoho Creator can be effectively used to develop a structured admission enquiry application with minimal coding, built-in validation, reporting, and workflow automation.

Hence, the Student Admission Enquiry Form was successfully created and tested using Zoho Creator, and the use of basic fields and low-code application development concepts was studied successfully.